



# christian brown

Engineering Manager

London, UK

Contact me

I'm a people manager and solutions architect with a background in world-class content management systems and online video workflows, backed by a decade and a half of experience with well-known, high-traffic, enterprise-level web properties created and maintained by globally distributed teams. I'm a strong proponent of high-quality, reusable, and maintainable solutions using SOLID design principles, automated testing, and continuous integration.

## current role

**Senior Engineering Manager**  
eBay in London, UK  
Aug 2022 - Now

I manage a team of 6-7 'full stack' engineers in the global shipping department, based in London with staff in Toronto and contractors in Cyprus. We are responsible for revenue-sensitive post-sales shipping experience for sellers on the web. We use carrier integrators to purchase shipping from couriers and postal services in the US, CA, UK, DE, and AU markets. We facilitate a range of workflows such as pay-on-print, pay-on-scan, bulk shipping, returns, tracking, insurance/claims, cross-border exports, and ship-to eBay Vault or eBay Authentication Guarantee centres. We process over 20m label purchases per month. The engineers build microservices in React, Node.js, Marko, and Java.

I have transformed the team from project/feature to product/ownership-driven, reduced production issues & customer-reported defects by over 50% and empowered engineers to think about architecture and maintainability over short-term results. I handle long-term planning, project management, stakeholder expectations, staff training, performance management, attrition, hiring, and promotions.

## previous roles

**Engineering Manager**  
Red Ventures in London, UK  
Aug 2021 - Jul 2022 (1yr)

I managed the central Video engineering team of 6 back-end engineers in the US and UK, with additional contractors from South America. We built a new SaaS video ecosystem to support up to two billion unique video-on-demand (VOD) play sessions per year. We also handled live-streaming, captioning, digital asset management, ads integration, analytics, and distribution. We onboarded CNET, ZDNet, GameSpot, GiantBomb, TV Guide, OnlineMBA, Cord Cutters News, BestColleges, NurseJournal and were in the process of bringing Healthline, Metacritic and LonelyPlanet onto our platform. We worked with vendors such as AWS Elemental, Fastly, Bitmovin, Rev, and Mux. The engineers built API orchestration and microservices in Node.js (Express) & Go/Golang (Goa), CMS integrations in PHP (Symfony, WordPress), and deployed into AWS and GCP with CircleCI on infrastructure managed with Terraform.

**Lead Software Engineer**  
Red Ventures in London, UK  
Nov 2020 - Aug 2021 (10mths)

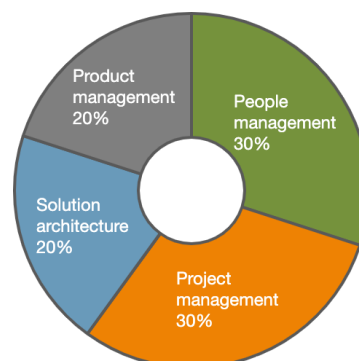
By acquisition from ViacomCBS, reporting to the VP of Engineering, I oversaw the migration of systems and workflows, including setting transition targets, undertaking vendor evaluations, and managing engineering deliverables & stakeholder expectations. I architected the replacement VOD solution based on GCP, Bitmovin and Fastly, which serves just shy of a billion video play sessions per year. Achievements include saving US\$430,000 first year and US\$275,000pa after that in costs for video content management by removing a vendor from our workflow with minimal impact on users and the business.

**Lead Software Engineer**  
ViacomCBS / CBS Interactive in London, UK  
Apr 2016 - Nov 2020 (4yrs, 7mths)

I was a team leader with direct reports, reporting to the VP of Engineering, part of a larger central CMS team of 13 engineers spread across the US, with support from product, PM, QA and DevOps. We maintained the CMS, REST APIs, and tech stack that powered web properties ViacomCBS operated internationally, including CBS News (inc. 60 Minutes), CBS Sports, 24/7 Sports, MaxPreps, SportsLine, CNET, ZDNet, TechRepublic, Download.com, TV Guide, and many more. My team were the subject-matter experts on all video-on-demand (VOD) content - interfacing with internal and third-party vendors for transcoding, storage, metadata management, captioning/transcription, ingestion, publishing, and distribution (e.g., YouTube). Achievements include saving US\$500,000pa from video playback costs, bypassing a third-party video platform, and avoiding the pay per play.

## my day

The "hats I wear" each day varies, but in my current role, on average, it's a bit like this:



I'm also known for making developer tooling and creating beautiful high-quality documentation.

## specialty verticals

I have subject-matter expertise in:



VOD



eCommerce



CMS

## tech

Some of the tech, frameworks and platforms I have recent industry experience with include:



JavaScript



TypeScript



Node.js



PHP



Symfony



Go



PostgreSQL



MySQL



Redis



Elemental



MPX/CVP



Bitmovin



JW Player



Video.js



Mux



Fastly



GCP



AWS



**Senior Software Engineer**  
**CBS / CBS Interactive in Singapore, then London, UK**  
*Jan 2012 – Apr 2016 (4yrs, 4mths)*

Initially based in Singapore as part of a team lead out of Sydney, we maintained a CMS that powered many of CBS Interactive's international brands. We built a new adaptive and responsive CMS user interface with just a few engineers within a couple of months for ZDNet. Out of that success, our teams merged with the US, building a CMS to power almost all of CBS' web properties, covering broadcast, news, sports, tech, gaming, and food verticals. I led the video workflow integration whilst based in San Francisco for 6wks.

**CNET** **Software Engineer / Web Developer**  
**CNET Networks in London, UK**  
*Sep 2007 – Jan 2012 (4yrs, 4mths)*

I was part of an international team supporting localised versions of CNET and ZDNet in the UK, AU, Asia, DE and FR. We developed a Zend-based framework used by engineers in those regions to handle scalability problems such as routing, caching and CDN integration. I also provided support for GameSpot, TV.com and TechRepublic. I delivered training in the Paris office to French and German teams; and presented our achievements at our off-site in Singapore.

**iiNet** **Associate Programmer**  
**iiNet in Perth, Australia**  
*Jul 2006 – Sep 2007 (1yr, 3mths)*

I was part of the Customer Service Tools team within the Applications Dept., responsible for developing and maintaining internal web-based applications to manage customers and staff. We built and supported CRM, billing, HR, and B2B ordering & monitoring systems that integrated third-party telecommunication APIs to process broadband applications with upstream providers (Telstra). I was awarded 'Hardest Worker of the Year' in 2006.

**iiNet** **Senior Customer Service Representative**  
**iiNet in Perth, Australia**  
*Jan 2005 – Jul 2006 (1yr, 7mths)*

I was a team leader in the contact centre, assisting and coaching customer service representatives, standing in for managers for customers with escalated technical or billing issues, identifying and lodging network-wide faults with operations and liaising with high-value clients. I created a set of web-based customer service tools, including a copper wire attenuation calculator based on raw telecommunications cable data to calculate the theoretical maximum DSL speed and a scheduling/roster user interface. The tools were used by all staff across Australian, NZ and South African offices. I was awarded 'Most Innovative Staff Member' in 2005.



**Freelance developer**  
 trading as **Clix Web Development in Perth, Australia**  
*Main trading period 2001 – 2006 (6yrs)*

I provided web development services for small to medium businesses, including hosting and domain name management. Based on my own CMS, I created and supported web properties from simple microsites to intranets and full shopping portals. I worked closely with clients, from concept and design to development, deployment, and support.



**IT Consultant/IT Administrator**  
**Mineral Engineering Technical Services (METS) in Perth, Australia**  
*Jan 2002 – Dec 2004 (3yrs)*

Oversaw IT operations, from desktop and server IT support to development, hosting and maintenance of their websites, intranet and other web-based tools. I also provided on-site IT support, consulting and web development for their clientele.

## education



**Bachelor of Computer Science, BCompSci (Hons)**

University of Western Australia (UWA)  
 Majored in **Electronic Business and IT Systems**.

## volunteering

**NHS** **NHS Volunteer Responder**

Royal Voluntary Service (RVS)  
 Science Museum Mass Vaccination Centre, London, UK  
*Mar 2021 – Sep 2021 (6mths), 420hrs (70x6hr shifts)*

## side projects



**Underpinned**  
 I run a non-profit micro-business, creating and selling pin badges for charity. See [underpinned.org](https://underpinned.org)



**Smart Home**  
 A 'just for fun' project: a dashboard of live external weather and internal temperature data from the home. See [/smart-home](#)



**Scan Pay Enjoy**  
 A work-in-progress project to enable small hospitality businesses to provide order-and-pay from tables using QR codes. Coming June 2023.